

Network policies in AKS

- By default, all pods within a cluster can communicate with each other with no restriction
- Network Policies can be seen as firewalls for pods
- Network Policies can be used to restrict network flow between pods
- AKS provides two options:
 - Azure Network Policy Manager
 - Calico
- `--network-policy {azure,calico}`
- For AKS clusters without network policy enabled, Kubernetes Network Policies can be created but they will have no effect

Capability	Azure Network Policy Manager	Calico Network Policy
Supported platforms	Linux, Windows Server 2022	Linux, Windows Server 2019 and 2022
Supported networking options	Azure CNI	Azure CNI (Linux, Windows Server 2019 and 2022) and kubenet (Linux)
Compliance with Kubernetes specification	All policy types supported	All policy types supported
Additional features	None	Extended policy model consisting of Global Network Policy, Global Network Set, and Host Endpoint. For more information on using the <code>calicoctl</code> CLI to manage these extended features, see calicoctl user reference .
Support	Supported by Azure support and Engineering team	Calico community support. For more information on additional paid support, see Project Calico support options .
Logging	Logs available with <code>kubectl log -n kube-system <network-policy-pod></code> command	For more information, see Calico component logs .

Source: <https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/azure/aks/use-network-policies>